Introduction to data organisation

Stephen J Eglen
https://sje30.github.io
sje30@cam.ac.uk

Cambridge Computational Biology Institute
University of Cambridge
@StephenEglen

Slides: http://bit.ly/eglen2019-data (HTML) (CC-BY license)

Acknowledgements / Declarations

Data parasites everywhere; Senior Editor at *Scientific Data*.

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Rule 1: Data should be shared

Given the cost of generating data, I think data relating to a publication should be shared along with the paper.

Funders (and increasingly many, but not all, journals) agree.

The Lancet

Longo DL, Drazen JM (2016) Data Sharing. N Engl J Med 374:276–277 http://dx.doi.org/10.1056/NEJMe1516564.

Data sharing sounds great … but

1. Someone not involved in collecting data may misunderstand it.

2. "a new class of research person will emerge --- people who had nothing to do with the design and execution of the study but use another group's data for their own ends, possibly stealing from the research productivity planned by the data gatherers, or even use the data to try to disprove what the original investigators had posited. There is concern among some front-line researchers that the system will be taken over by what some researchers have characterized as **research parasites''**."

Response from the community was to embrace the term "resesarch parasite", e.g. https://twitter.com/dataparasite

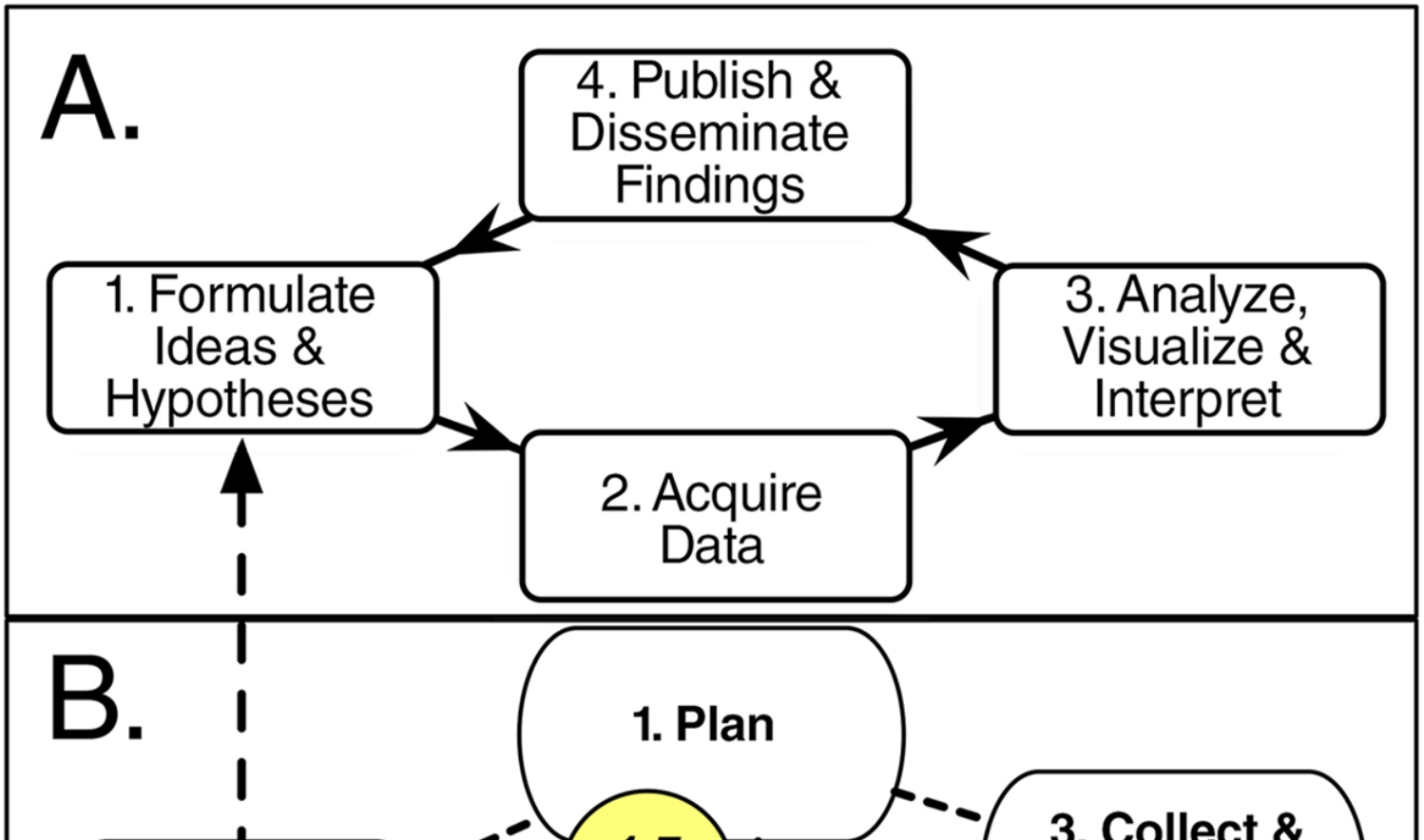
This is just good science. I think there are few valid reasons for not sharing data.

Why share your data?

Biggest beneficiary might be your future self. See also "Selfish reasons" in next talk.

Writing a good data management plan (DMP)

Michener WK (2015) Ten Simple Rules for Creating a Good Data Management Plan. PLoS Comput Biol 11:e1004525
http://dx.doi.org/10.1371/journal.pcbi.1004525.



FAIR data standards

Box 2 | The FAIR Guiding Principles

To be Findable:
F1. (meta)data are assigned a globally unique and persistent identifier
F2. data are described with rich metadata (defined by R1 below)
F3. metadata clearly and explicitly include the identifier of the data it describes
F4. (meta)data are registered or indexed in a searchable resource

To be Accessible:
A1. (meta)data are retrievable by their identifier using a standardized communications protocol
A1.1 the protocol is open, free, and universally implementable
A1.2 the protocol allows for an authentication and authorization procedure, where necessary
A2. metadata are accessible, even when the data are no longer available

To be Interoperable:
I1. (meta)data use a formal, accessible, shared, and broadly applicable language for knowledge representation.
I2. (meta)data use vocabularies that follow FAIR principles
I3. (meta)data include qualified references to other (meta)data

To be Reusable:
R1. meta(data) are richly described with a plurality of accurate and relevant attributes
R1.1. (meta)data are released with a clear and accessible data usage license
R1.2. (meta)data are associated with detailed provenance
R1.3. (meta)data meet domain-relevant community standards

https://www.nature.com/articles/sdata201618

Things to be wary of

GDPR, Ethics, anonymisation.

Getting help

CambridgeData Champions (phd students, postdocs, faculty)
https://www.data.cam.ac.uk/data-champions-search

Office for Scholarly Communication

a model adopted elsewhere

The Turing Way

Losing your data

We all know the stories of PhD students losing their laptop, and along with it their only copy of their data. But there is a flip side:

Licence

What restrictions to share your code?

CC0

Don't edit the raw data files.

Keep pristine (e.g. read-only) in own folder.

Difficulties with current approaches

- Who pays for mybinder instances?
- "Reproducible forever" is a BIG challenge. My first attempt lasted about 6 months. Dockerhub for waverepo. Is "forever" achievable/useful?
- Interactive approach suitable for shorter jobs. But how about for long jobs (days--months)?
- Do editors / reviewers have time to check that code and data work? I can recall only one comment (positive!) about running my code by a reviewer.
- Pushing the bar up and up is good for quality, but how practical is it? What is "good enough?"

What is "good enough"?

Barnes (2010) convinced me that something is better than nothing.

Published online 13 October 2010 | *Nature* **467**, 753 (2010) | doi:10.1038/467753a

Column: World View

Publish your computer code: it is good enough

Freely provided working code — whatever its quality — improves programming and enables others to engage with your research, says Nick Barnes.

Nick Barnes

"All models [**papers/programs**] are wrong but some are useful"

Not everyone agrees: Milkowski et al 2018 suggest that paper should contain only key material.

Spreadsheet

- http://www.codecheck.org.uk
- CODE CHECK will be a system for generating "Certificates of Computation"
- These state that code was run on a given date on a given platform and generated particular results (figures, tables).

Dates

https://xkcd.com/1179/

Spreadsheets

Broman KW, Woo KH (2018) Data Organization in Spreadsheets. Am Stat 72:2–10 Available at: https://doi.org/10.1080/00031305.2017.1375989

Ten simple rules for the Care and Feeding of Scientific data

Goodman A, Pepe A, Blocker AW, Borgman CL, Cranmer K, Crosas M, Di Stefano R, Gil Y, Groth P, Hedstrom M, Hogg DW, Kashyap V, Mahabal A, Siemiginowska A, Slavkovic A (2014) Ten simple rules for the care and feeding of scientific data. PLoS Comput Biol 10:e1003542
http://dx.doi.org/10.1371/journal.pcbi.1003542

Find a decent repo

Guidelines from PLOS and Scientific Data

https://journals.plos.org/plosone/s/data-availability#loc-recommended-repositories

https://www.springernature.com/gp/authors/research-data-policy/repositories/12327124

General repo: Zenodo / figshare

Many universities have own repository, but I find this the wrong way to cut the cake (prefer by subject, not location)